



'INDIA CAN ACHIEVE 100 GW NUCLEAR POWER BEFORE 2047'

Bhuwan Chandra Pathak, CMD, Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd, talks about the potential of nuclear power in meeting decarbonisation goals of energy-intensive industries. Edited excerpts:



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Your comments on India's nuclear energy scenario roadmap.

Nuclear power is clean and environment friendly, apart from having an enormous potential to ensure the country's long-term energy security.

A large nuclear power expansion programme is therefore under implementation. Today, we have 25 operational nuclear power reactors in the country contributing about 9 GW of clean power to the national grid. About 17 reactors are presently under various stages of implementation in the country.

We have set a target

of reaching about 22 GW of installed nuclear power capacity within the third decade (2032). We also have plans for setting up more reactors based on our indigenous technology and with collaboration with foreign partners.

Every possibility of surpassing the 100 GW (target) will be welcome. As far as technology is concerned, we have the strength now in the country. The entire system is available. What we must do is speedy implementation of the project.



What role can the private sector play in scaling up nuclear

power capacity in the country?

The Indian private sector is contributing in a big way to the country's nuclear power programme by manufacturing and supplying core reactor components, equipment and materials and executing jobs and providing numerous services. The private sector includes not just large industries but also many MSMEs. We continuously strive to develop more vendors, including those from the marginalised castes, and women entrepreneurs.

The large-scale capacity addition would require the private

industry to enhance its capacity in terms of infrastructure and human resources.

Another area where the private sector could contribute is bringing investments. A request for proposal (RFP) for setting up Bharat Small Reactors (BSRs) for decarbonisation of hard-to-abate industries with private investment has already been floated. It is an evolving process starting with 220 MW capacity design. The response is overwhelming. So, with passage of time, the 220 MW BSRs today can be of larger capacity tomorrow.

We want to have more institutions